

operating systems with loads of visual appeal. They also have one of the most popular video formats around, especially if it's movie trailers you want to watch online.

We should mention that QuickTime is not a Codec, but actually a player for playing video in the .mov file format. You can still find many tools to convert MPEG or AVI files to MOV files with smaller file sizes using lossless compression.

If you think that this is a lot of Codecs, and things seem to be getting complicated, you should pay a visit to <http://www.fourcc.org/Codecs.php> for an even bigger list of hundreds of Codecs, all of which you may come across when working with or viewing video files. There seems to be no limit to the amount of Codecs out there, and we wouldn't blame you for being overwhelmed by the amount of reading you and downloading you would need to do to get all of these.

Though your media player should automatically download a required Codec when it comes across a video file that uses an unsupported one, this doesn't always work out as well. As a result, if you are a Windows Media Player user, generally, you end up getting a dialog box that says something to the effect of "Codec not found". Thankfully, as is usual, others have had the same problems, and found a solution for you.

Codec Packs

You can now get what are called Codec packs from the Internet. These packs contain the most commonly used Codecs for video on the Net, and install them all automatically.



KLite Codec Pack

This is a Codec that was popularised by users of KaZaA Lite, the popular peer-to-peer file sharing application. It contains a pretty impressive list of audio and video Codecs.